

QA, on documentation, translations, in support, on different flavours of Ubuntu and many, many other things.

What I admired most was how many teams got professionalised over the years. In the beginning, there was a lot of 'pioneer spirit'—everything was new, many new ideas came up and were tried out; later on, big events were organised by teams and daily quality for Ubuntu became a more important topic.

Without the help of all these people, there wouldn't have been regular, always improving releases every six months.

Q What is the easiest way for a newbie to join the Ubuntu community?

A while ago, we set up <http://community.ubuntu.com>, which makes it a lot easier to find out which initiatives are active in Ubuntu and where, depending on your skills and interest, you might want to get involved.

The spectrum of contributors is very wide. We had 10-12 year-olds contributing a lot to Ubuntu, and have also had retired people. It was wonderful to see how quickly many took on leadership roles, learned more, found friends across continents and together brought free software to millions of people.

Q Can you explain the MOTU programme being spearheaded by you and how it can benefit a newbie contributor?

If you are interested in developing Ubuntu, to fix bugs in the Ubuntu platform, integrate software packages into Ubuntu, this is a great place to learn how. The MOTU team is a group of very approachable and helpful people who can help you with your first steps in fixing small bugs in Ubuntu, updating packages, improving integration and lots more. <http://packaging.ubuntu.com/> should be a good place to get started.

The great thing is that everything is open source and you can learn a lot very quickly by getting involved here.

Q What should we look forward to in Ubuntu 14.04?

14.04 is going to be an important release for Ubuntu. It will be another long-term support (LTS) release, so it will be stable, reliable and something we can support for five years on Desktop and on Server.

While this doesn't sound too exciting on its own, at the same time there is a lot of work going into Ubuntu for phones and tablets, which is already flowing into 'standard Ubuntu'. In the future, all form-factors are going to use the same code base, and there will be one converged Ubuntu. This is very exciting and will be available as a preview on Desktop.

Q Ubuntu Edge could not manage to gather the required funds. Does your team have any plans to revive the project in any way?

Canonical is currently working with a number of handset manufacturers and carriers on bringing Ubuntu phones to the market. This is one big focus right now, so I haven't heard of discussions about a new Ubuntu Edge.

Q It is reported that Canonical will debut Mir Display Server for Ubuntu Linux in 2014. What changes will Mir bring to the user experience?

The Mir team is working on bringing a seamless and fast replacement for the X Display Server. It's already working great on phones and tablets, and is available for users to try out on the Desktop as well. For 14.04, it won't be the default, though.

Q With the coming of Sailfish and Tizen, where do you see Ubuntu for phones and tablets?

The great thing about Ubuntu is that it's going to be the same Ubuntu running on the server, in the cloud, on your desktop, laptops, tablets, phones and TVs. The user experience will be similar. Apps will be written once and run everywhere. This, plus the ability to share data across all the devices, and Ubuntu's active and helpful community are great selling points.

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Q What are you doing to develop an ecosystem for Ubuntu for phones and tablets? Do you think it will be able to take on an already successful proposition called Android?

By supporting both HTML-5 and QML/JavaScript and making it very easy to get secure apps into the software store, the experience for app developers is seamless and they can put apps together quickly.

Unity's system of scopes will also make it easy to add differentiation for carriers and manufacturers. This way, they can easily and intuitively provide content to users.

Another great point is Ubuntu's openness. It doesn't matter if you are a user, an app developer, a manufacturer or a carrier, you can very easily get involved. The roadmap is public and planning also happens publicly.

Q What is Ubuntu adoption like in India?

I talked to Maria Bonnefon, who is director of Channel and Market Development at Canonical, and she said that uptake of Ubuntu in India is tremendous. Several of Canonical's partners in India are working towards furnishing Ubuntu solutions.

On a more personal note, when I stayed in Mysore as part of my holidays, I was asked by somebody what I did for a living. When I answered that I worked on Ubuntu, I got this response: "Oh Ubuntu - it's fantastic. We replaced Windows with it in our school some time ago, we're so much happier now."

Moments like this make working on Ubuntu just great.

Q Do you have some community involvement plans specific to Indian Ubuntu fans? If yes, please share the details.

If you are interested in app development, watch out for the next Ubuntu App Showdown. It's likely to happen in January